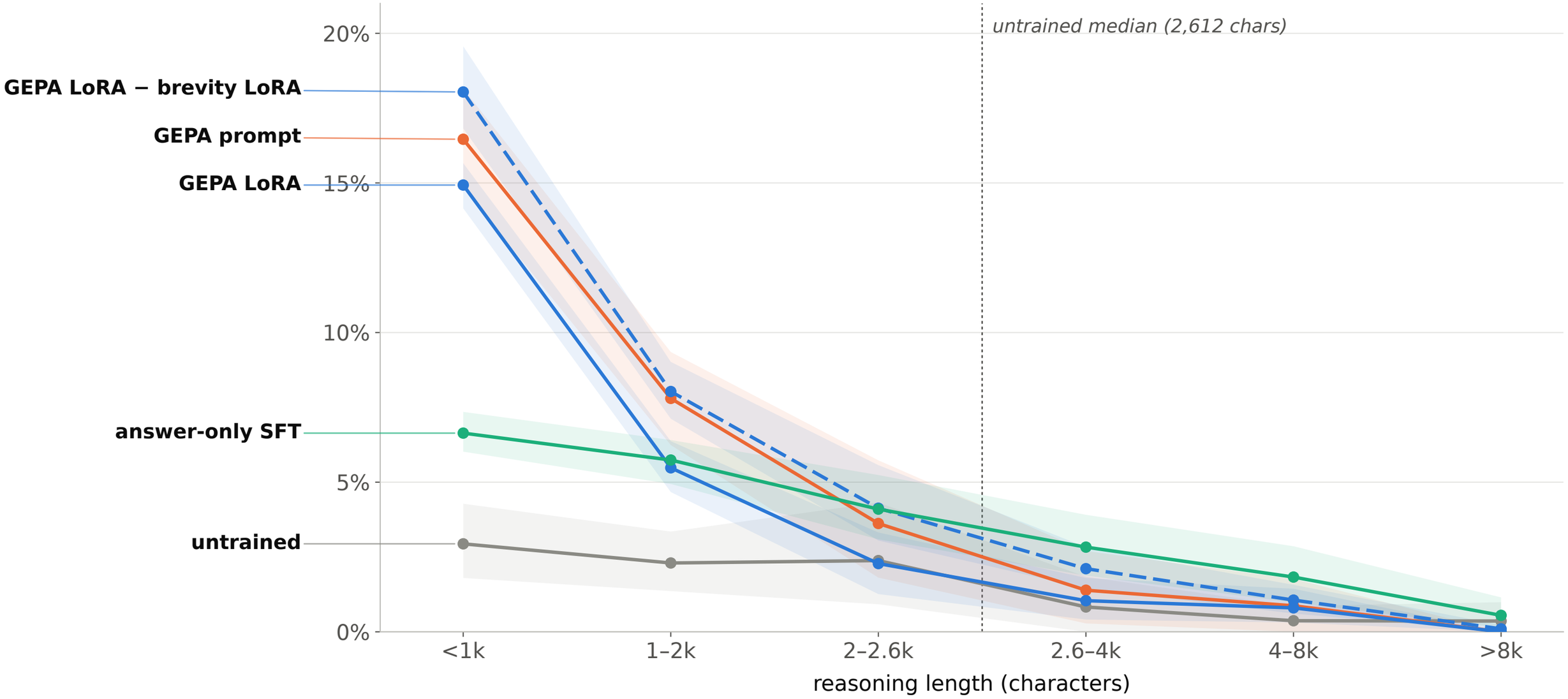
CoT control is a function of reasoning length: above 2.6k characters no arm exceeds 2%

gpt-oss-20b, test split, per reasoning-length bin (9 instructions pooled; LoRAs pooled over 3 seeds); bands = 95% bootstrap CI over traces



Bins hold 2–55% of each arm's traces (fewest: GEPA LoRA >8k, 2%); compliance = followed the instruction, answered, reasoning not degenerate.